Volunteer Handbook

Lowmoor Folk & Lantern Festival · 16–18 July 2027

Welcome

Thank you for volunteering at the twelfth Lowmoor Folk & Lantern Festival. More than four hundred volunteers make the festival possible, from the people who build the lantern trail to those who greet visitors at the gate. This handbook explains what we expect of you and what you can expect from us.

Please read it before your first shift and keep it with you during the festival weekend.

1. Before the festival

1.1 Registration

Every volunteer must complete the online registration form and choose at least three shifts. Volunteers under 18 need a signed consent form from a parent or guardian.

1.2 Training sessions

Session	Date	Time	Venue
General induction	Saturday 19 June	10:00–12:00	Lowmoor Town Hall
Gate and wristbands	Wednesday 30 June	18:30–20:00	Festival office
Stage crew safety	Saturday 3 July	09:00–13:00	Main stage field
Lantern workshop	Sunday 4 July	14:00–17:00	Old Mill Studios

The general induction is compulsory for everyone, including volunteers who have helped in previous years.

2. Volunteer roles

A. Gate and wristbands

- checking tickets and exchanging them for wristbands
- counting entries every hour and reporting the figures to the control room

B. Stage crew

- moving equipment between acts
- keeping the backstage area clear
  - no visitors without a backstage pass
  - no glass bottles at any time

C. Lantern trail

- helping children carry and light their lanterns
- guiding the procession along the river path

3. Shifts

Shifts last four hours and include a twenty-minute break. Please arrive fifteen minutes before your shift starts.

Shift	Friday 16 July	Saturday 17 July	Sunday 18 July
Morning	—	08:00–12:00 Meet at the volunteer tent	08:00–12:00 Meet at the volunteer tent
Midday	12:00–16:00 Meet at the main gate	12:00–16:00 Meet at the main gate	12:00–16:00 Meet at the main gate
Afternoon	16:00–20:00 Meet at the main gate	16:00–20:00 Meet at the river path	16:00–20:00 Meet at the river path
Evening	20:00–00:00 Meet at the control room	20:00–00:00 Meet at the lantern trail	—

4. Health and safety

Your safety and the safety of visitors come first. Wear your volunteer tabard at all times while on duty, and drink plenty of water in hot weather.

- Report any hazard to your team leader straight away.
- Do not lift anything heavier than you can manage comfortably.
- Never block an emergency exit or a fire lane.

In an emergency

Call the control room on channel 1 of your radio, or dial the number on the back of your pass. Stay with the casualty until a first-aider arrives.

Lost children

Take the child to the welfare tent next to the main gate and stay with them. Never leave a lost child alone, even for a moment.

5. Code of conduct

As a volunteer you represent the festival, and we ask you to follow these rules:

(i) Treat visitors, artists and other volunteers with courtesy and respect.

(ii) Do not drink alcohol before or during a shift.

(iii) Do not post photographs of children or of the backstage area on social media.

(iv) Tell your team leader if you cannot attend a shift, as early as possible.

6. Contacts

Role	Name	Telephone
Volunteer coordinator	Tamsin Rowe	07700 900 341
Site manager	Gareth Pryce	07700 900 562
First aid post	Lowmoor First Responders	07700 900 118
Lost property	Festival office	01632 960 774

7. After the festival

Every volunteer who completes three shifts receives a free weekend ticket for next year's festival. We will also send you a short survey, and your answers help us to improve the volunteer programme.

Thank you again, and enjoy the festival!